PROactive PRONUNCIATION

“AH” /a/ Spelling

Over 80% of the time, we spell the /a/ “ah” sound with an "o." Words like "mop, hop, and rot" will all have the /a/ sound. Where it gets tricky is the other 20%. Unfortunately, in these scenarios, the only thing left to do is memorize those "outsider" exception words. However, if you remember the basic generality, you will fix most of your /a/ issues.

o Most common spelling as in “on, off, not”

au as in “auto”

al as in “calm, chalk, stalk, walk, talk, all, always”

a as in “want, father, wander”

aw as in “crawl”

Less common spellings:

oa as in “broad”

ou as in “cough”

ow as in “knowledge”

*Remember, if there is an “e” at the end of the word, the rule does not apply. E.g. “robe.”
*Words like “to” /tu/ and “so” /so/ and “no” are exceptions and will not be pronounced with the /a/ sound.